to understand the effects of variable combinations of traits and situations that may influence their decision-making and stress reactivity'. The researchers looked at the personality of the athletes but also their ability to monitor their stress levels—in other words to self-control.

While most of us aren't extreme athletes, many us at some point can experience varying degrees of financial stress, and our ability to monitor our stress levels and to self-control is key to financial stability. That monitoring and regulating doesn't necessary include financial habits. Perhaps it's engaging with apps that use assisted meditation techniques, turning off our mobile phone, placing our email on hold, moving our body, increasing our sleep and using devices that regulate and improve our sleep patterns. They're all techniques we can use to reduce our stress levels and, in doing so, protect our finances.

When we're thinking about a plan to deal with how we behave financially when we're stressed, I think it's helpful to look at those who are already planning well for stress—in the world of business.

Starbucks, for example, regularly and consistently teaches its employees how to handle stressful situations in the workplace with something they call 'inflection points'. Inflection points are stressful moments during the day—for example it could be an encounter with a customer who is complaining. Employees are taught to practice their response to these inflection points over and over again so that when the stressful situation happens in real life, their response is chosen through habit rather than an uncontrolled, automatic fight or flight stress response.

Here we're doing the same thing. It's first recognising the stressors or inflection points in your life, second having a plan that anticipates how you will surmount these moments in time and then finally practising that plan and those habits for when the inflection points or stressors arise.

As for what these habits will look like in real life, I thought I'd share a few from my experience.

I've shared in Chapter 4 how my Money Story is about 'not enough' and ensuring I have enough power, safety and control. When life stressors appear, or when I feel backed into a corner or stripped of power and control, I tend to try to gain them back somehow. Often the easiest way to do that is with my finances. As a Discerner Money Type, I'm often prone to